

Setting up appointment reminders for clients

The appointment reminder (also visit reminder, SMS reminder of appointment, push notification of upcoming visit) is sent to the client automatically a fixed time before the visit and reduces no-shows. The **Appointment reminder** page in the notifications module controls how far in advance to send the reminder, which channels to use (Email, SMS, messengers, branded app, WhatsApp), and the message template.

When to use

- When clients regularly miss appointments and the no-show rate needs to drop.
- When the reminder needs to arrive earlier than 1 hour before the visit so the client can reschedule in time.
- When several delivery channels are connected and a fallback order is needed: branded-app push first, SMS only if the push did not deliver, and so on.

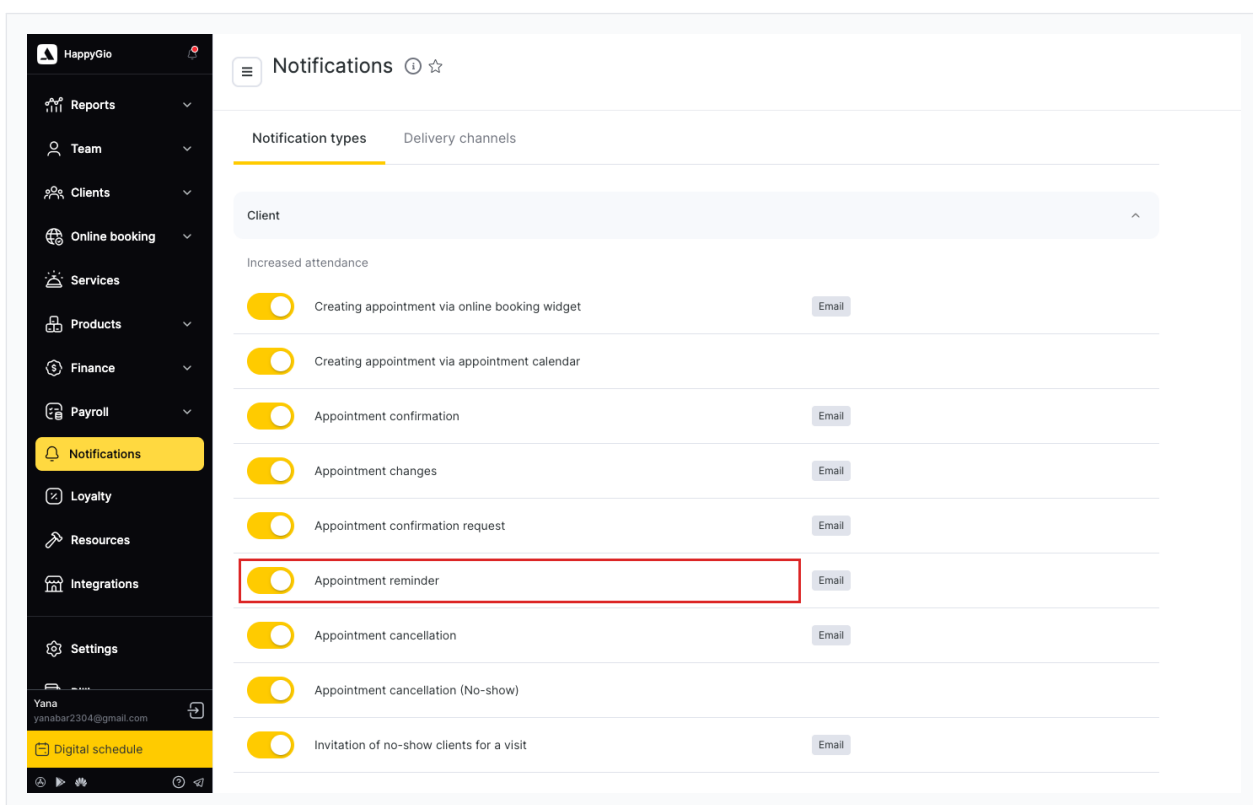
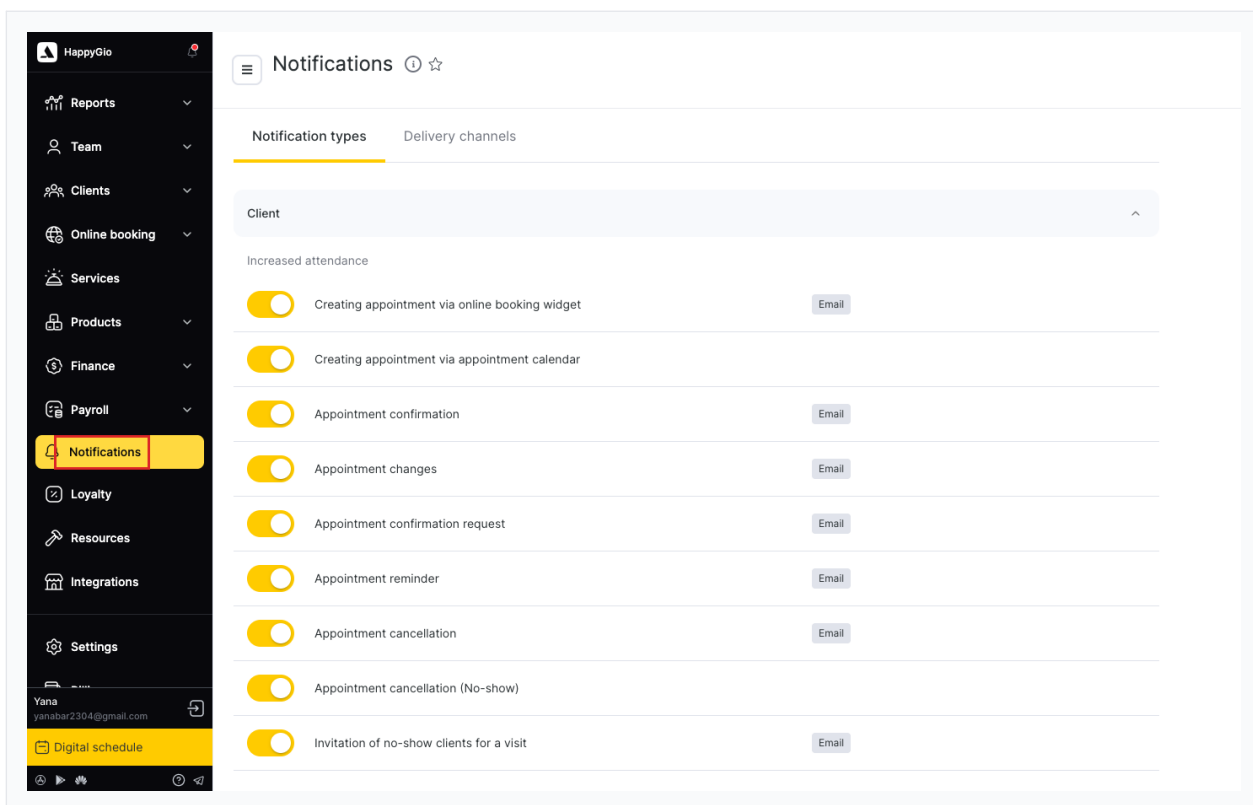
What you need first

- **Connected delivery channels:** at least one channel must be active (Email is on by default). SMS, WhatsApp, and the branded app require connection through the **Not connected** block on this page.
- **Team-member access right: Notifications** must be granted in **Team** → **Team members list** → **[name]** → **Access**.

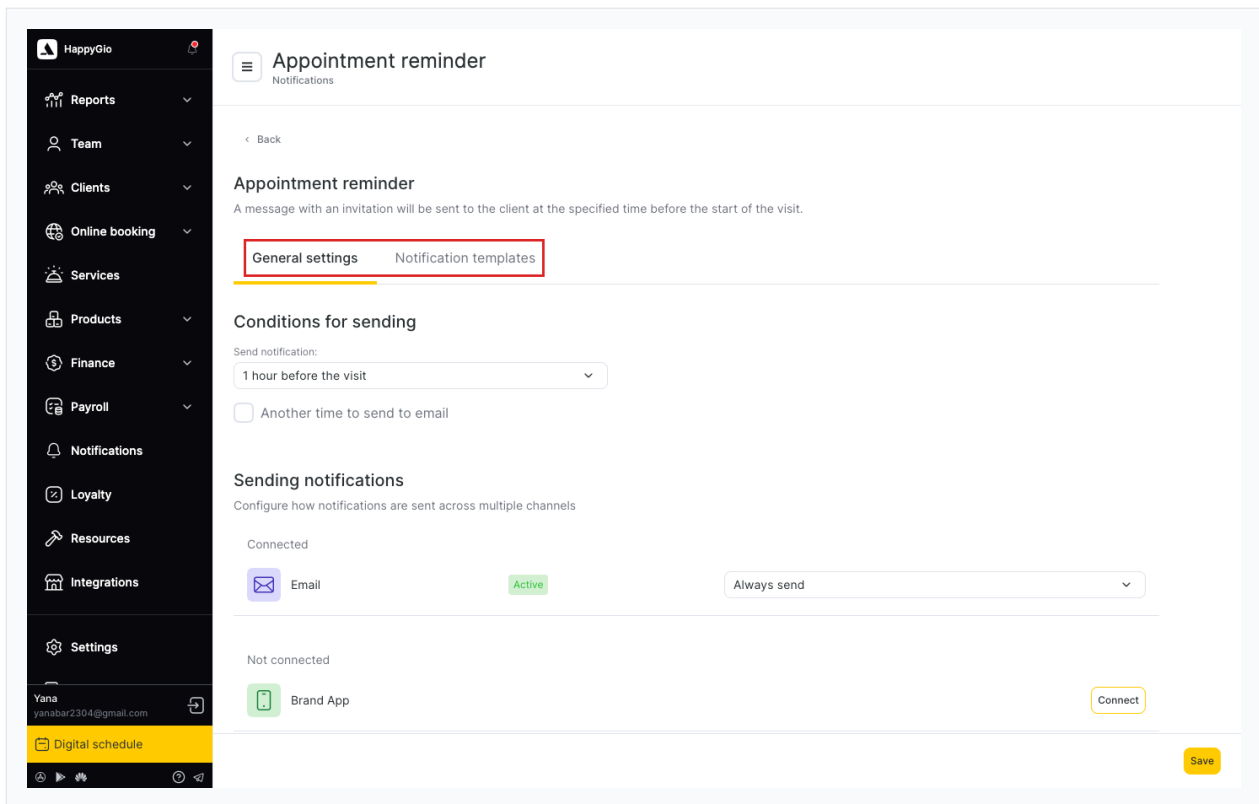
How to set up

Step 1. Open the appointment reminder page

1. In **Administration** mode, click **Notifications** in the left sidebar.
2. On the **Notifications** page, in the **Notification types** column, under **Client** → **Increased attendance**, locate the **Appointment reminder** row.
3. Click that row to open the configuration page.

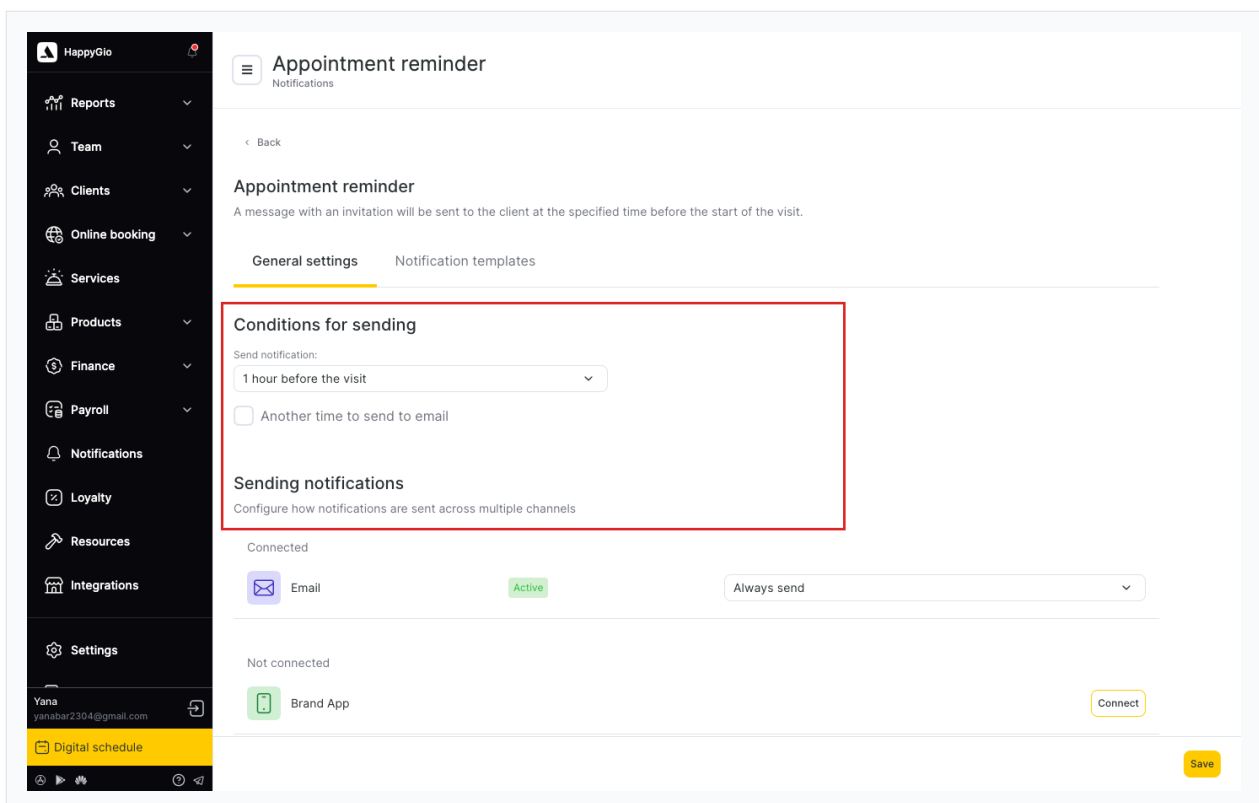


Open the **General settings** tab. The instructions return to **Notification templates** in step 4.



Step 2. Set the send time

The **Conditions for sending** section controls how far in advance the reminder is sent.



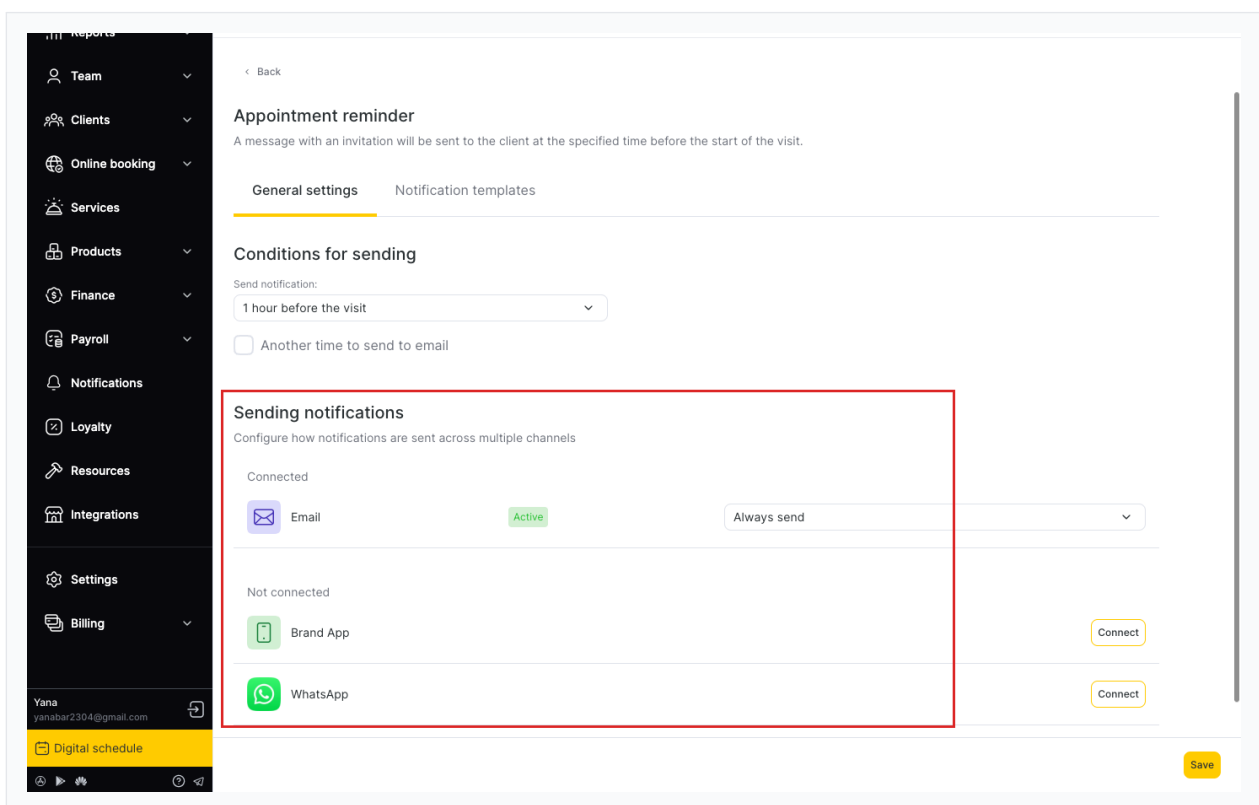
1. In the **Send notification** field, choose how long before the visit the reminder should go out. The dropdown lists **1 hour**, **2 hours**, **3 hours**, **4 hours**, **5 hours**, **6 hours**, **9 hours**, **12 hours**, **15 hours**, **18 hours**, **21 hours**, and **24 hours** before the visit.
2. If Email needs a different timing (earlier or later than the main one), enable the **Another time to send to email** checkbox and pick a value in the **Send an email notification** field that appears. The same set of values is available.

NOTE

When **Another time to send to email** is off, the Email reminder is sent at the same time as the other channels. When it is on, Email is sent independently of SMS and push.

Step 3. Configure delivery channels

Scroll down to the **Sending notifications** section. This is where the channels and their order are configured.



The section has two blocks: **Connected** and **Not connected**.

Connected

Channels that already work for your location. Each channel exposes:

- **Active toggle** — turns the channel on or off for this specific notification.

- **Delivery rule** — a dropdown with two values:

- **Always send** — the reminder goes through this channel regardless of other channels.

- **Send if delivery via the previous channel failed** — the reminder uses this channel only if the previous one in the list did not deliver. This rule saves SMS quota when push notifications are an option.

The order of channels in the list determines priority. By default **Email** is first and runs in **Always send** mode; **SMS + Messengers** sit second and can run as a fallback.

IMPORTANT

A warning may appear inside the Connected block: «Message.Help provider may ignore Altegio settings. You need to check the settings on the provider side.» This means that final SMS and messenger delivery depends on the provider configuration in addition to the Altegio settings.

Not connected

Channels not yet activated for your location. To enable a channel, click **Connect** next to it:

- **Brand App** — push notifications inside your custom-branded mobile app for clients.

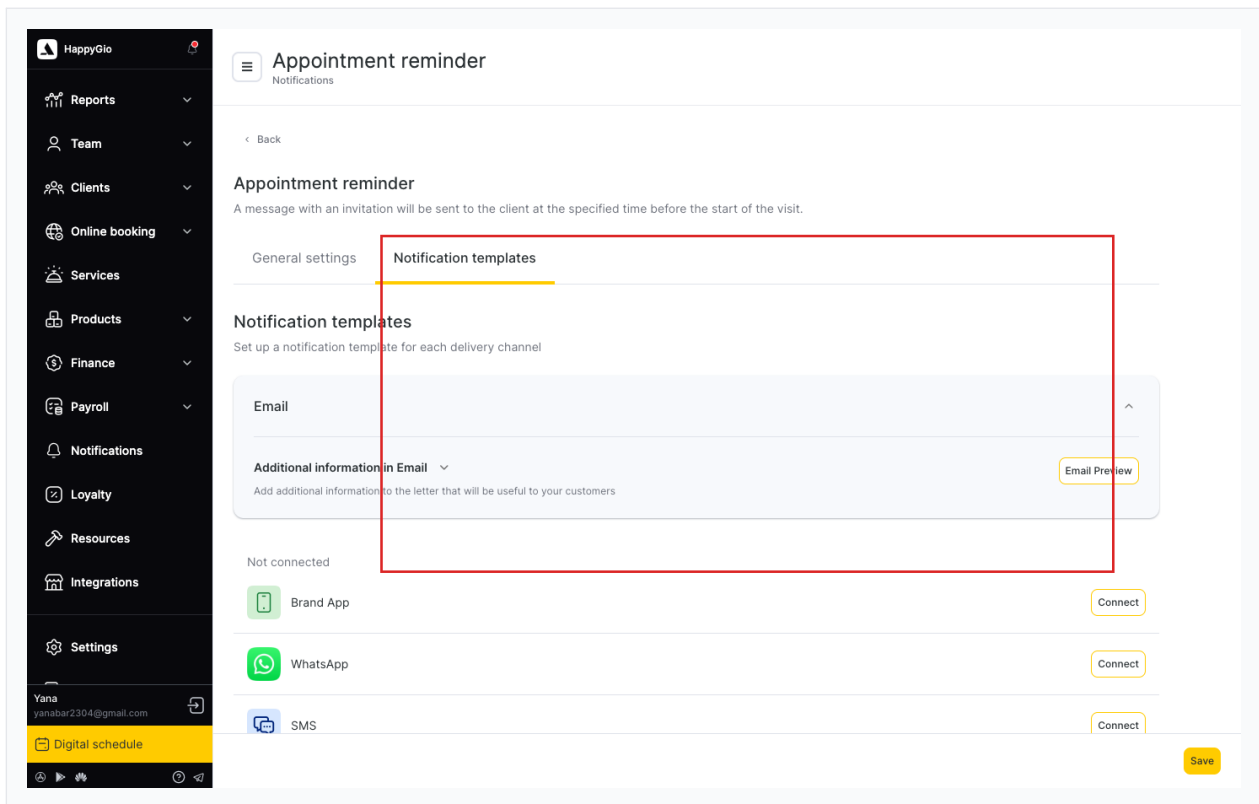
- **WhatsApp** — delivery through WhatsApp Business.

- **SMS** (if no SMS provider is connected) — standard text messages.

After connection the channel moves to the **Connected** block and becomes available for configuration.

Step 4. Edit the message template

Switch to the **Notification templates** tab. This tab controls the message text shown to the client, separately for each channel.



The section is titled **Notification templates** with the description «Set up a notification template for each delivery channel».

Email

- **Additional information in Email** — a free-text field added to the standard email body. Use it to communicate cancellation rules, address details, parking, and similar useful info.
- **Email Preview** — opens a rendered preview of the email with sample data.

SMS and messenger template

- **Message text** — the template used for SMS, WhatsApp, and other text channels.
- Variables are inserted via the **Add variable** button. The available variables include:
 - **Team member name**
 - **Time until appointment**
 - **Appointment date and time**
 - **Appointment details link**
- A **Notification preview with test data** block under the template field shows how the message will look once variables are substituted.

Step 5. Save

Click **Save** in the bottom-right corner of the page. The new configuration applies to every reminder sent from this point on.

Result

After saving, the system automatically sends a reminder to every client with an active appointment at the configured time before the visit. The notification goes out through the channels enabled in the **Sending notifications** section, in the order they are listed. Email is sent independently if **Another time to send to email** is on. The message text is built from the template on the **Notification templates** tab with real variable values substituted.

Where the reminder appears in other parts of Altegio

The settings on the **Appointment reminder** page are global defaults, but the reminder produces visible records and can be overridden in three other places.

Messages report (delivery log for the whole location)

Every sent reminder is logged in **Reports** → **All reports** → **Messages**. To open it from any page, expand **Reports** in the left sidebar and click **All reports**, then click the **Messages** card.

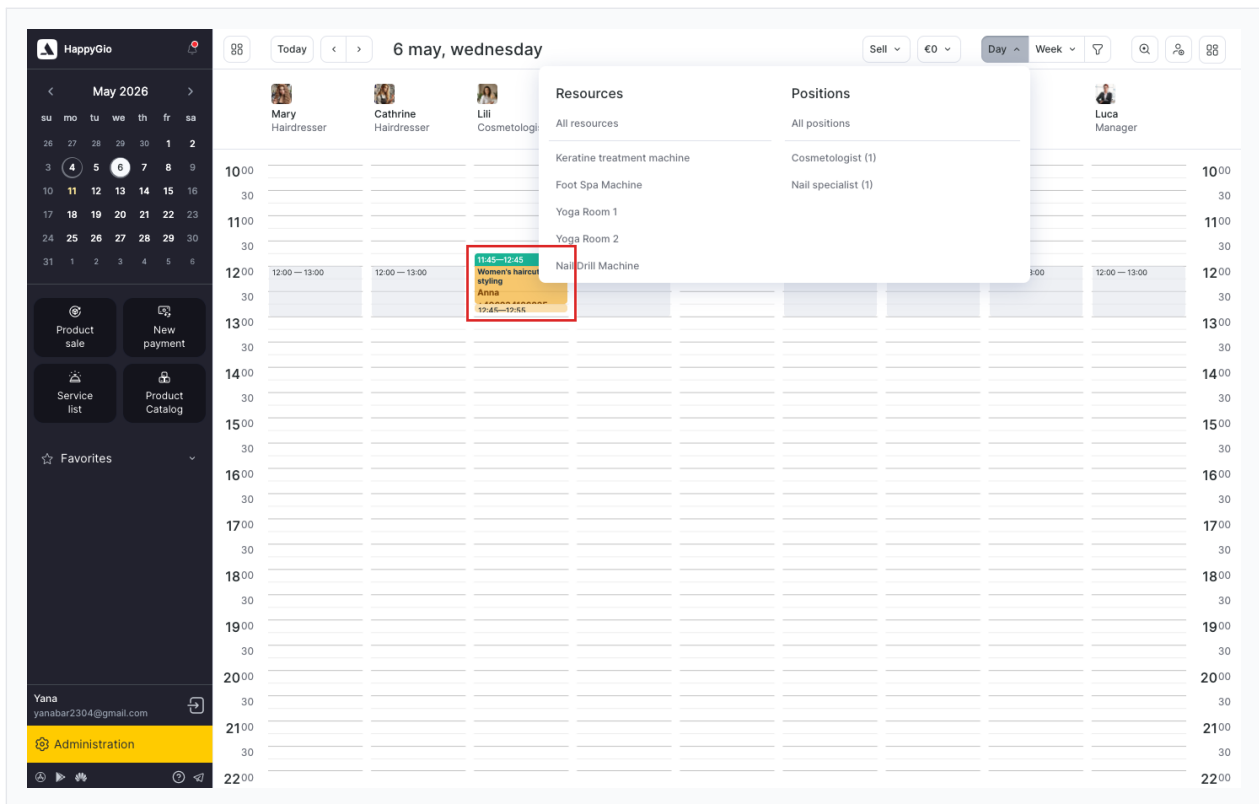
The report has columns **Date / Contact details / Contents / Message type / Status / Number of messages / Channel / Cost / Aggregator** and filters by date, message type, status, phone, provider, and channel. Status values include **Sent**, **Failed to deliver**, **Read**, and **Sent to the phone number**. Use this report to confirm whether a specific reminder reached the client.

Date	Contact details	Contents	Message type	Status	Number of messages	Channel	Cost	Aggregator
Fri, 08.05, 11:49 am	sasha.s@alteg.io	Location Management Invitation HappyGio	employee invitation to company management	Failed to deliver Fri, 08.05, 11:49 am	1	Email	0	-
Thu, 07.05, 05:40 pm	sasha.h@alteg.io	Location Management Invitation HappyGio	employee invitation to company management	Failed to deliver Thu, 07.05, 05:41 pm	1	Email	0	-
Thu, 07.05, 05:38 pm	sasha.h@alteg.io	Location Management Invitation HappyGio	employee invitation to company management	Failed to deliver Thu, 07.05, 05:38 pm	1	Email	0	-
Thu, 07.05, 05:16 pm	sasha.k@alteg.io	Location Management Invitation HappyGio	employee invitation to company management	Failed to deliver Thu, 07.05, 05:16 pm	1	Email	0	-
Wed, 06.05, 11:45 am	zsombor.b@alteg.io	Korábbi időpontfoglalás	an invitation to a follow-up visit	Read Wed, 06.05, 11:45 am	1	Email	0	-
Wed, 06.05, 11:43 am	tutorais@alteg.io	The booking was deleted by the client or admin	deletion of appointment via the Internet (receptionist)	Sent Wed, 06.05, 11:43 am	1	Email	0	-

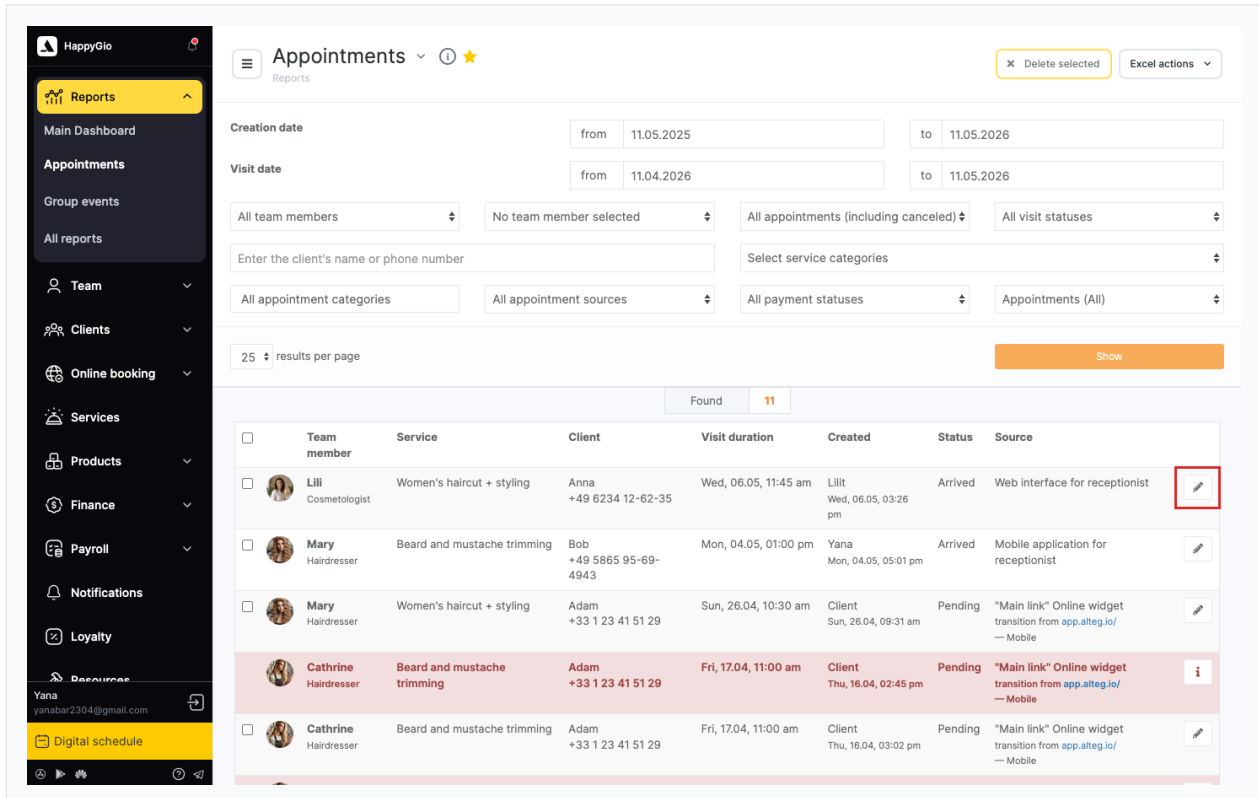
Appointment window — Notifications tab (per-appointment override)

There are two ways to open the appointment window. Use the one that fits your workflow.

In Digital Schedule (the default mode for daily reception work), click the appointment cell directly in the calendar.



In Administration mode, go to **Reports** → **All reports** → **Appointments**, find the appointment in the list, and click the pencil icon at the right of the row.



Both paths open the same appointment window. Switch to the **Notifications** tab. The **Pre-visit reminder** block contains **Notification method** and **Notify before the visit in:** fields for SMS and Email. The values here override the global settings for this single appointment. The same tab also exposes **Appointment confirmation**, **Repeat visit reminder**, and **Send a message** (manual one-off send for this appointment). Click **Save** at the bottom to apply.

Notifications [Close]

Appointment confirmation
The notification will be sent to clients via the selected delivery channels.

Email [Send]

Pre-visit reminder

Notification method	Notify before the visit in:
☒ SMS	1 hour
☒ Email	1 hour

Repeat visit reminder
The notification will be sent to clients via the selected delivery channels.

Email [Send]

Provided service	How long after the visit
Women's haircut + styling	14 days

Send a message

Message text
[Enter message text]

[Send a message] [Save]

Right Sidebar:

- Client Card:** Lili, Cosmetologist. 6 May, 11:45-12:45 - 1 hour. Technical break, 10 minutes. Resources, Not selected. [Delete app]
- Explore the updated interface in just a minute** [Start onboarding]
- Pinned fields:** Appointment comments
- Advanced fields:** [Repeat], [Consumables used], [Notifications], [History]

Client card — Messages and calls tab (per-client log)

In **Clients** → **Client Database**, find the client in the list and click the client name to open the client card.

Client card — Notifications tab (per-client subscription)

In the same client card, the **Notifications** tab controls which notification types this client receives. The list of types includes **Upcoming visit** (the reminder). For each type, you can choose **Available Channels** (Push, SMS, Email) or set **Newsletters: Do not send** to opt the client out entirely.

The screenshot shows the 'Client Database' interface. On the left, there's a search bar and a list of clients with columns for Name, Phone, and Email. The right panel is titled 'Notification settings' and includes sections for 'Newsletters', 'Available Channels', and 'Notification types'. The 'Available Channels' section has checkboxes for Push, SMS, and Email, with Push and SMS checked. The 'Notification types' section has a list of notification types, each with a toggle switch. The 'Push' and 'SMS' checkboxes are highlighted with a red box.

Name	Phone	Email
Isabella	+49 8121 65-56-0	
Ava	+34 33 951 21 61	
Logan	+44 880011479	
Ethan	+44 425958964	
Elijah	+44 498015640	
Ava	+44 459698795	
Benjamin	+33 3 42 31 12 29	
Benjamin	+44 954156508	
Emily	+44 5829285393	
James	+33 1 63 02 12 18	

Notification settings

Newsletters

☐ Do not send

Available Channels

☒ Push

☒ SMS

☒ Email

Notification types

☐ Upcoming visit ⓘ

☐ Review request – Online booking ⓘ

☐ Review request – Appointment calendar ⓘ

☐ New appointment – Online booking ⓘ

☐ New appointment – Appointment calendar ⓘ

☐ Birthday greetings ⓘ

☐ Booking confirmation – Online booking ⓘ

☐ Booking deleted – Online booking ⓘ

☐ New discount ⓘ

☐ Discount expiry reminder ⓘ

☐ Follow-up appointment reminder ⓘ

25 results per page

Save

Frequently asked questions

How long before the visit does the reminder go out?

The send time is set in the **Send notification** field of the **Conditions for sending** section. Available values are 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 18, 21, and 24 hours before the visit. This timing applies to every channel except Email, when Email has a separate time.

How do I make Email arrive earlier than SMS?

In the **Conditions for sending** section, enable the **Another time to send to email** checkbox and select an earlier value in **Send an email notification**, for example **24 hours before the visit**. SMS stays on the main timing set above.

Clients are not receiving SMS reminders.

Check: is the SMS channel still in the **Not connected** block on the **Appointment reminder** page? If it is, click **Connect** to activate it. If SMS is in **Connected**, verify that **Active** is on, and that the delivery rule is **Always send** or that the previous channel is failing to deliver. If a Message.Help warning is shown, also check the provider configuration on the provider side. Also open **Reports** → **All reports** → **Messages** and check the **Status** column: if it shows **Failed to deliver**, the issue is with the provider or the phone number; if there is no row for the expected date, the issue is with the channel configuration.

How do I check if the reminder was actually delivered to a client?

Open **Reports** → **All reports** → **Messages**. Filter by the visit date and the client's phone or email. The **Status** column shows the delivery state: **Sent**, **Failed to deliver**, **Read**, or **Sent to the phone number**. The **Message type** column marks visit reminders as **appointment reminder**.

Where can I see all reminders sent to a specific client?

Open the client card in **Clients** → **Client Database** by clicking the client name in the list. Switch to the **Messages and calls** tab and view the **Sent messages** sub-tab. It lists every notification ever sent to this client.

How do I change the reminder time for one specific appointment?

Open the appointment window by one of two paths: in **Digital Schedule**, click the appointment cell in the calendar; in **Administration**, go to **Reports** → **All reports** → **Appointments** and click the pencil icon on the row. In the appointment window, switch to the **Notifications** tab. In the **Pre-visit reminder** block, change the **SMS** and **Email** values in the **Notify before the visit in:** field. The change applies only to this appointment and overrides the global setting. Click **Save** at the bottom.

How do I disable reminders for a specific client?

Open the client card in **Clients** → **Client Database** by clicking the client name in the list. Switch to the **Notifications** tab and either uncheck channels (Push / SMS / Email) for the **Upcoming visit** type, or set **Newsletters: Do not send** to opt the client out of all notifications.

How do I include the team member name in the reminder text?

On the **Notification templates** tab, place the cursor at the right spot in the **Message text** field and click **Add variable**. Pick **Team member name** from the list. Verify the substitution in the **Notification preview with test data** block before saving.

Can the reminder go through several channels at once?

Yes. In **Sending notifications** → **Connected**, turn on **Active** for each desired channel and pick **Always send** in the dropdown next to it. The reminder will be sent through every channel independently.

How do I save SMS quota when clients have the mobile app?

In **Sending notifications** → **Connected** put **Brand App** above SMS in the channel list. For SMS, set the dropdown to **Send if delivery via the previous channel failed**. SMS will only be sent to clients who did not receive the push notification in the app.

See also

- Connecting an SMS provider to Altego
- Setting up the appointment confirmation request
- Setting up the post-visit feedback request
- Granting access rights to a team member
- Messages report — checking delivery status
- Client card — Notifications tab